

The Week Ahead **Global Economy**

Fed chair Powell to fight his corner at Jackson Hole

Bankers gather in Wyoming, European heads fly to Washington for vital Ukraine war peace talks, big box retailers report



From left, US Federal Reserve chair Jay Powell, Bank of Canada governor Tiff Macklem and Bank of England head Andrew Bailey at last year's Jackson Hole gathering © AP

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Hello and welcome to the working week.

August in the northern hemisphere is a month for escaping the office grind, and the politics, by spending some time in nature. Some of the world's most important central bankers will be doing just that later this week in the wide open spaces of Wyoming, where the annual Jackson Hole economic policy symposium takes place.

But this will be a works outing, not a holiday, especially for the US Federal Reserve chair Jay Powell. He and other Fed officials will arrive at the Jackson Lake Lodge in Grand Teton National Park on Wednesday with intrigue swirling as to who will become the next head of the US central bank. If you are interested (and a premium subscriber), my colleague Robin Wigglesworth on Alphaville has penned an [assessment of the runners and riders](#).

Aside from the political manoeuvring, Powell's biggest challenge in what will almost definitely be his last appearance at the Jackson Hole gathering is going to be conveying a relatively clear monetary policy outlook message, given the splits in the Federal Open Market Committee on the next interest rate move. We'll get some more clarity on that last issue when the minutes from the last FOMC meeting are published on Wednesday.

Powell will no doubt be glad that he will be joined in Jackson Hole by Bank of England governor Andrew Bailey — who has already [voiced his support](#) for the Fed chair — as well as his Canadian counterpart Tiff Macklem. Powell will no doubt be relieved also that Stephen Miran, the man US President Donald Trump has chosen to temporarily fill the FOMC seat vacated by Adriana Kugler's abrupt departure, will not be travelling to Jackson Hole. However, the shadow of Trump will loom large over proceedings.

Politics this week begins, and possibly ends, with vital Ukraine peace talks at the White House in Washington, where the country's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy will on Monday convene with British Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer alongside a “[coalition of the willing](#)” of EU leaders. To get up to speed with Russian President Vladimir Putin's demands, [read this](#).

The latest, and [remarkably good](#), Wall Street earnings run is slowing down to a jog. But the coming days will see a flurry of reports from “big box” US retailers, including **Walmart**, **Home Depot** and **Target**. Two key questions are being asked about this sector: how is the US consumer holding up? And what will be the effect of higher tariffs on consumer prices?

The national economic data for US consumer confidence is not good, showing tepid spending online and on Main Street this year. Shoppers feel “broadly negative” about the US economy, according to the University of Michigan’s closely watched survey. However, the situation is complex as my colleague, the FT’s consumer editor, Gregory Meyer found on a recent trip to Cincinnati, where shoppers were displaying a [surprising bullishness](#).

The main theme from the broader economic data run this week will be inflation, with updates due from Canada, the EU, Germany, Japan and the UK. The latter will just give an update on the consumer price index inflation figure, however, as the producer price index measure was [cancelled by the Office for National Statistics](#) in March. More details on these and other items below.

One more thing...

The last of the annual tennis grand slams, the US Open, gets under way in the late summer heat of Flushing Meadows, New York, this week. But if you are one of the growing army of padel enthusiasts, you should read FT columnist Jemima Kelly’s take [on the sport](#) and the way it showed her the physical and mental benefit of taking up new playful activities, something I wholeheartedly endorse.

How are you spending your free time this month? Email me at jonathan.moules@ft.com or, if you are reading this from your inbox, hit reply. Have a good week.

Key economic and company reports

Here is a more complete list of what to expect in terms of company reports and economic data this week.

Monday

James Wroath becomes the new **Keller Group** CEO, succeeding Michael Speakman

Kirk Tanner becomes president and CEO of **Hershey**, succeeding Michele Buck

EU: June/Q2 business registrations and bankruptcies data

Germany: June building permits data

UK: card spending statistics from UK Finance. Also, the monthly Rightmove House Price Index

Results: **Lendlease** FY, **Palo Alto Networks** Q4

Tuesday

Canada: July consumer price index (CPI) inflation rate data

Germany: June manufacturing index

UK: July insolvency figures

US: July state employment figures

Results: **BHP** FY, **Coloplast** 9M, **CSL** FY, **Home Depot** Q2, **International Workplace Group** HY, **James Hardie Industries** Q1 (Wednesday AM local time in Australia), **Keysight Technologies** Q3, **Medtronic** Q1, **Woodside Energy** HY

Wednesday

Reserve Bank of Australia assistant governor (business services)

Michelle McPhee and assistant governor (financial system) Brad Jones take part in an online panel discussion at [The Future of Money](#) webinar

Raphael Bostic, president and chief executive of the **Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta**, takes part in a moderated conversation at Fintech South 2025 about monetary policy and an economy that works for everyone

China: interest rate announcement

EU: July harmonised index of consumer prices (HICP) inflation rate data

France: Q2 new home sales

Germany: July industrial products producer price index (PPI) inflation rate data

Indonesia: interest rate announcement

Israel: interest rate announcement

New Zealand: interest rate announcement

Sweden: interest rate announcement

UK: July CPI inflation rate data

US: minutes from July 29-30 rate-setting meeting published

Results: **Alcon** Q2, **Analog Devices** Q3, **APA** FY, **Costain** HY, **Estée Lauder** Q4, **Geberit** HY, **Ithaca Energy** HY, **Jack Henry & Associates** Q4, **Kenmare Resources** HY, **Lion Finance** Q2/HY, **Lowe's** Q2, **OSB** HY, **Target** Q2, **TJX** Q2

Thursday

Australia: July labour force data

Eurozone, France, Germany, India, Japan, UK, US: S&P Global/HCOB purchasing managers' index (PMI) data

Norway: Q2 GDP estimate

South Korea: July PPI inflation rate data

UK: July public sector finances data. Also, monthly CBI Industrial Trends Survey.

Results: **Aegon** HY, **AIA** HY, **Goodman** FY, **Hays** FY trading update, **Intuit** Q4/FY, **Nordson** Q3, **Novonesis** HY, **Ross Stores** Q2, **Walmart** Q2, **Workday** Q2, **Zoom** Q2

Friday

Germany: Q2 GDP estimate

Japan: July CPI inflation rate data

UK: July Great Britain retail sales figures plus GfK's consumer confidence survey

Results: **Cathay Financial Holding** Q2

World events

Finally, here is a rundown of other events and milestones this week.

Monday

Financial Times Business Book of the Year longlist [announced](#)

UK: High Pay Centre publishes annual survey of FTSE 100 CEO pay packages, analysing the pay of senior executives of British publicly quoted companies and comparing the median CEO pay with the median earnings of a UK full-time worker

US: European leaders including German Chancellor Friedrich Merz, UK Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer, French President Emmanuel Macron, Italian premier Giorgia Meloni, Finnish President Alexander Stubb and European Commission president Ursula von der Leyen will join President Volodymyr Zelenskyy in a vital White House meeting with US President Donald Trump on Ukraine war peace talks.

Tuesday

Italy: anniversary of the superyacht Bayesian sinking off the coast of Sicily during bad weather, resulting in the deaths of seven of the 22 people onboard, including British tech tycoon [Mike Lynch](#) and his 18-year-old daughter Hannah

US: 145th US Open Mixed Doubles Championship opens on the tennis courts of Flushing Meadows, New York. The men's and women's singles contests, the last grand slam tournaments of the year, begin on Sunday

Wednesday

UK: James Harding, co-founder of Tortoise Media, editor-in-chief of The Observer and former FT Washington bureau chief, delivers the 50th James MacTaggart Memorial Lecture, the Edinburgh TV Festival's keynote speech

Thursday

UK: quarterly and annual immigration statistics published, covering people coming to Britain, extending their stay, gaining citizenship, applying for asylum and being detained or being removed. Also, GCSE results day for schools in England, Wales and Northern Ireland for exams taking young people to the next stage of secondary education

US: The three-day Jackson Hole economic policy symposium begins in Wyoming, attended by central bankers, finance ministers, academics and executives from the financial sector. The annual event, hosted by the Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City, is this year called Labor Markets in Transition: Demographics, Productivity, and Macroeconomic Policy

Friday

Russia: National flag day

South Korea: People Power party to decide a new leader from a shortlist of four at its national convention. The embattled conservative party's support [has plummeted](#) after disgraced former PPP president Yoon Suk Yeol was removed from office

UK: Silverstone Festival, an annual three-day motorsport and music festival held over the bank holiday weekend, begins at the Northamptonshire racetrack. This year's event celebrates 75 years of Formula 1 racing

Saturday

International Day for the Remembrance of the Slave Trade and its Abolition

Japan: South Korean President Lee Jae Myung begins a two-day state visit, where he will hold a summit with Prime Minister Shigeru Ishiba

Taiwan: parliamentary recall elections

US: Bank of England governor Andrew Bailey speaks at Jackson Hole economic policy symposium

Sunday

Australia: World Solar Challenge, 1,860-mile contest in which competitors drive solar-powered and electric concept vehicles they designed and built themselves from Darwin to Adelaide

UK: London's Notting Hill Carnival, celebrating Caribbean culture, begins with families and children's day

Ukraine: Independence Day public holiday

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